



PRESS, NEWSPAPERS, NEWS AGENCIES AND BOOKS REGISTRATION (AMENDMENT) ORDINANCE, 2007

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PRESS, NEWSPAPERS, NEWS AGENCIES AND BOOKS REGISTRATION (AMENDMENT) ORDINANCE, 2007

ORDINANCE LXIV OF 2007

An Ordinance to amend Press, Newspapers, News Agencies and Books Registration Ordinance, 2002

WHEREAS it is expedient to amend the Press, Newspapers, News Agencies and Books Registration Ordinance, 2002, (XCVIII of 2002), for the purposes hereinafter appearing;

AND WHEREAS, the National Assembly is not in session and the circumstances exist which render it necessary to take immediate action;

NOW, THEREFORE, in exercise of the powers conferred by clause (1) of Article 89 of the Constitution of the Islamic Republic of Pakistan, the President is pleased to make and promulgate the following Ordinance:-

1. Short title and commencement.---(1) This Ordinance may be called the Press, Newspapers, News Agencies and Books Registration (Amendment) Ordinance, 2007.

(2) It shall come into force at once.

2. General Amendment, Ordinance XCVIII of 2002.---In the Press, Newspapers, News Agencies and Books Registration Ordinance, 2002 (XCVIII of 2002), hereinafter referred to as the said Ordinance, after the words “District Coordination Officer”, wherever occurring, the words and commas “or, where the District Government has not come into being the Deputy Commissioner” shall be inserted.

3. Insertion of new section 5A, Ordinance XCVIII of 2002.---In the said Ordinance, after section 5, the following new section shall be inserted, namely:--

“5A. Restriction on publication of certain material.---(1) No printer, publisher or editor shall print or publish in any book, periodical or paper any material which consists of,---

- (a) photographs or pictures of suicide bombers, terrorists (except as required by law-enforcing agencies for purposes of investigation), bodies of victims of terrorist activities, statements and pronouncements of militants and extremist elements and any other thing which may, in any way, promote, aid or abet terrorist activities or terrorism;
- (b) graphic or printed representation or projection of statements, comments, observations or pronouncement based on sectarianism, ethicism or racialism;
- (c) any material, printed or graphic, that defames, brings into ridicule or disrepute the Head of State, or members of the Armed Forces or executive, judicial or legislative organs of the State.

- (d) any material that is likely to jeopardize or be prejudicial to the ideology of Pakistan or the sovereignty, integrity or security of Pakistan;
- (e) any material, photographic or in print, that is likely to incite violence or hatred or create inter-faith disorder or be prejudicial to maintenance of law and order; and
- (f) any material that is in conflict with the commonly accepted standards of morality and decency and which promotes vulgarity, obscenity, and pornography.”

4. Amendment of section 19, Ordinance XCVIII of 2002.---In the said Ordinance, in section 19, after subsection (2), for the full stop, at the end, a colon shall be substituted and thereafter the following proviso shall be inserted, namely:

“Provided that in a situation of emergency, pending action under this section, the District Coordination Officer, or as the case may be, the Deputy Commissioner, may suspend the declaration for a period not exceeding thirty days, as deemed appropriate in the circumstances.”

5. Amendment of section 44, Ordinance XCVIII of 2002.---In the said Ordinance, in section 44, for the word “Government” the words “Federal Government in consultation with the Provincial Governments” shall be substituted.
